

Azure DevOps Remote MCP

Use the hosted server with read-first controls and Foundry-managed continuity

Source: <https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/devops/release-notes/2026/sprint-278-update> · +2 in notes

Two status labels

Azure DevOps Remote MCP Server

- Generally available in Sprint 278
- Azure DevOps hosts and updates it
- Streamable HTTP endpoint

Foundry Add Tools catalog entry

- Current page says “Azure DevOps MCP Server (preview)”
- Creates a project connection and tool selection
- Track this integration label independently

Remote first, local when auth blocks you

Feature	Remote	Local
Hosting	Azure DevOps hosted	Your machine
Transport	Streamable HTTP	stdio
Installation	None	Node.js 20+ and npx
Authentication	Microsoft Entra ID OAuth	PAT or Microsoft Entra ID
Updates	Managed by Azure DevOps	Managed by you

Prerequisites

- **Azure DevOps Services** — Active organization backed by Microsoft Entra
- **Not supported** — Standalone MSA organizations
- **Not the target** — On-premises Azure DevOps Server
- **Permissions** — Membership and access to every queried or changed resource

The endpoint is organization-scoped

```
https://mcp.dev.azure.com/{organization}
```

Filter by toolsets or exact tools

X-MCP-Toolsets

- Group filter: wit, repos, wiki, pipelines, and others
- Good for a bounded domain
- Do not combine with X-MCP-Tools

X-MCP-Tools

- Exact tool-name allow-list
- Good for least-privilege scenarios
- Do not combine with X-MCP-Toolsets

Read-only is a server-side filter

```
{  
  "headers": {  
    "X-MCP-Toolsets": "wit",  
    "X-MCP-Readonly": "true"  
  }  
}
```

D E M O

~5 min

Read-only ADO MCP in action

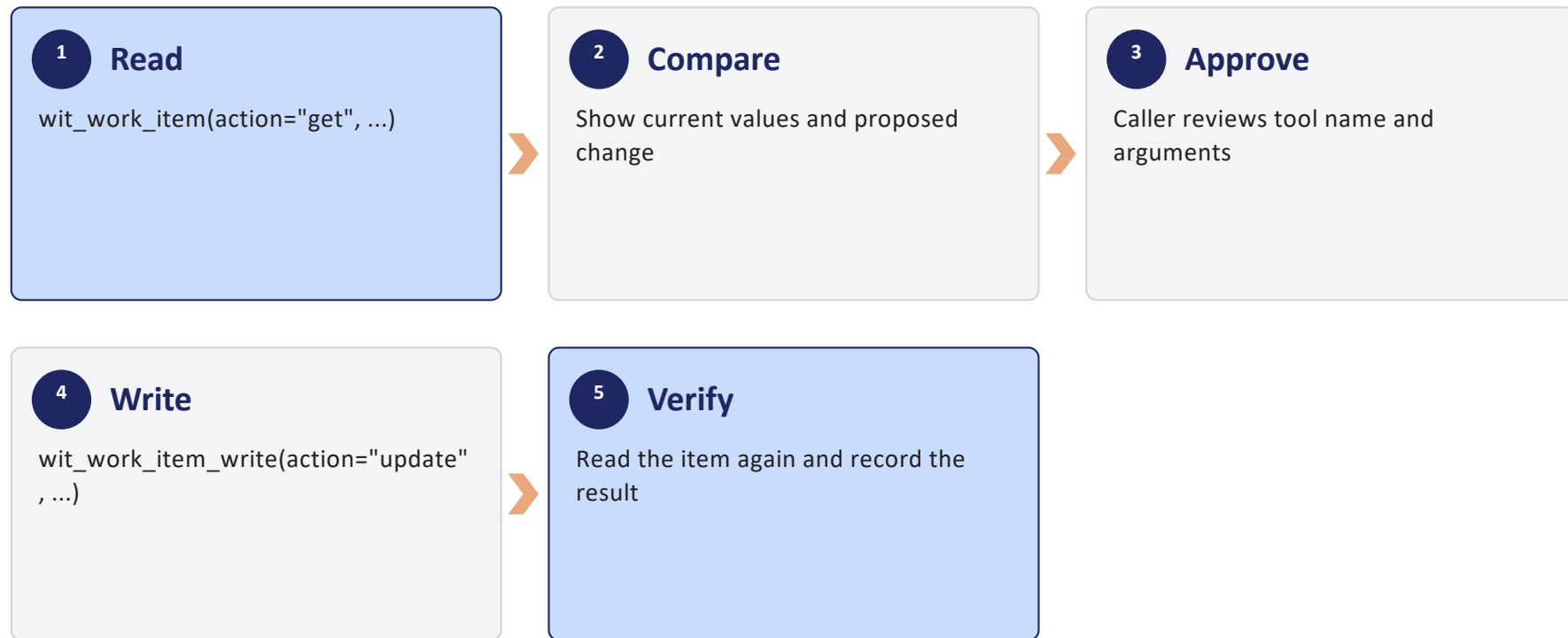
Connect to the presenter's own Azure DevOps organization with X-MCP-Toolsets: wit and X-MCP-ReadOnly: true: a `wit_work_item(action="get")` read succeeds, and an attempted write is rejected by the server — the filter is enforced server-side, not by convention.

Runbook: [demos/day3/module-6-demo-1-read-only-ado.md](#)

Work item tools (wit)

Tool	Example actions	Risk
wit_work_item	get, get_batch, my, list_for_iteration	Read-only
wit_work_item_write	create, update, update_batch, add_child	Write
wit_work_item_comment_write	add, update	Write
wit_work_item_link_write	link, unlink, link_to_pull_request	Write

Use a read-first, approved-write sequence



Two supported paths — not one wizard

Foundry agent path

- Add Tools → Catalog → Azure DevOps
- Authenticate through a project connection
- Select the smallest required tool subset

Local MAF path

- Consume an existing Toolbox MCP endpoint
- Authenticate to the Toolbox with supported Entra auth
- Treat upstream MCP credentials as Toolbox-managed

OAuth consent belongs to the connection path

Project connection

Stores authentication details instead of app code

Consent

First OAuth-backed toolbox call can return `CONSENT_REQUIRED`

Retry

Complete the consent URL, then retry the call

Boundary

Do not claim an undocumented direct local MAF-to-ADO OAuth recipe

Failure modes tell you where to look

Symptom	Check first
Sign-in or consent fails	Entra-backed org, tenant policy, enterprise app consent
Tool is missing	X-MCP-Toolsets / X-MCP-Tools / read-only filters
Tool returns forbidden	Signed-in user's project and resource permissions
Write tool unavailable	X-MCP-Readonly and exact tool allow-list
Invalid operation	Current tool name plus documented action

Workshop guardrails

Scope

Dedicated workshop project and least-privilege user

Discover

wit only, read-only first

Approve

Explicit review before every write

Audit

Caller, tool, action, arguments, decision, and verification result

Takeaways

- ✓ You treat the remote server GA status separately from the Foundry catalog preview label.
- ✓ You choose remote first when your client supports Entra OAuth.
- ✓ You filter with Toolsets or exact Tools, never both.
- ✓ You start with X-MCP-Readonly: true.
- ✓ You use consolidated tool names and inspect each action.